

SOMETHING ABOUT HER

Written by

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1 INT. BEDROOM - MORNING

The alarm clock buzzing on the nightstand reads 7:00 am. Next to the alarm clock is a photo of two young children, laughing. A hand reaches over and pats around the nightstand, finally stopping when it reaches the clock and hits the snooze button.

JOSIE, 35, is laying on the right side of the bed, the other half empty. Light coming from the open curtains shines on her, leaving the other side of the bed in the dark. Messy hair covers her face.

Josie sighs a couple of times before resting on her elbows, elevating her upper body. She soothes her hair back and turns to look at the alarm clock.

JOSIE

Oh shit!

Josie pulls the covers off of herself and jumps out of bed. She rushes into her adjoining bathroom.

2 INT. MASTER BATHROOM

Josie begins getting ready. She pulls her hair back into a ponytail, the first hairband snaps. She flinches.

Her daughter VICTORIA, 15, stands at the entrance of Josie's bedroom. MADELYNE, 10, Josie's youngest daughter, follows behind.

VICTORIA (O.S.)

Mom, we're gonna be late!

MADELYNE (O.S.)

Mommy! Can you brush my hair?

Josie places a second hairband between her lips while she gathers her hair into a ponytail once more.

Josie finishes putting her hair back and shuts her eyes. She steadies herself with both hands on the edges of the bathroom sink. She sighs and turns her head down. She opens her eyes and stares at herself in the mirror.

3 EXT. CONVENIENCE STORE PARKING LOT - LATER

JOSIE

Fuck, fuck, fuck, fuck, FUCK!

The car has a flat tire. Josie kicks the tire and slumps down to the asphalt, leaning on the car door.

TERR (pronounced t-air), 27, professional photographer, peers out of her driver's side window and witnesses the scene. She pulls her car into the spot next to Josie's and steps out. Dawning a leather jacket, she approaches Josie and squats down to her level on the ground.

TERR

Hey, you need some help?

Josie looks up at Terr. She stands up and turns to look at her tire once again.

JOSIE

Potentially... yeah.

TERR

No problem, I have a friend that works at the autoshop a couple blocks away. I'll text her.

Terr pulls out her phone and starts texting.

JOSIE

Oh, you don't have to do that really. It's just been, uh, rough morning and I didn't think it could get any worse until now.

Terr puts the phone into her back pocket and looks back up to Josie. She reaches out to shake Josie's hand.

TERR

I'm Terr by the way. I, uh, I think I've seen you at drop-off a few times. I help my sister out a few times a week and take my nephew to school.

JOSIE

Oh, yeah, uh, maybe. Sorry if I haven't made an effort to get to know you, my life has been all over the place lately.

Josie pans her hands down her body, displaying her stained, oversized t-shirt. Terr follows her hands and laughs. Her phone buzzes and she reaches into her pocket to retrieve it.

TERR

My friend said she could be here in about an hour, if that's cool with you. Maybe we could grab a coffee while you wait, destress a little?

Josie looks at Terr and then back at her car, sighing. She shrugs.

JOSIE

Sure, I'd love to.

4 INT. COFFEE SHOP

Josie and Terr are seated at a table near the window, facing one another. They both have hot drinks in front of them. Josie shifts in her seat, glances around the store, and crosses her arms over her body uncomfortably.

TERR

Here, take my jacket.

Terr takes off her leather jacket and hands it to Josie over the table. Josie smiles and takes the jacket, shrugging it on over her t-shirt.

JOSIE

Thanks. It's been a bit chaotic around the house lately, I didn't have time to grab anything nicer.

TERR

I think you look great. Trust me, I'd know. Hot moms are kinda my thing.

Josie and Terr laugh.

JOSIE

Wow, I feel like I haven't left the house in so long. I'm forgetting how to act.

TERR

Why? Hubby got you tied up?

JOSIE

No, actually, I'm recently divorced. He was a dick, he wanted more outta life, I was too boring, the usual crap... and now I have to take the kids to school every morning, the dentist, doctors, soccer practice, cheerleading... cook, clean the house, do the laundry. And god forbid I do anything wrong or I'll get an earful from my ex or my oldest daughter who is turning out to be just like him.

Josie pauses and sighs. She looks down at her lap and then back up to meet Terr's eyes.

JOSIE (CONT'D)

Sorry for ranting, I've just been kind of stressed lately if you couldn't tell.

TERR

Well, then why don't we... distress. This weekend, you and me, hit Murphy's on 5th.

JOSIE

You know what, sure. I think I deserve a drink.

5 INT. NIGHTCLUB -- NIGHT

CLUB BOUNCER lets Josie past the velvet rope. Lights flare, IDs are checked, hands are stamped. She is dressed in a short, tight, dark dress with heels. Josie pulls the neckline of her dress up and the hem of the dress down.

Terr is talking with a group of friends on the other side of the bar. She spots Josie, excuses herself, and starts to walk over.

TERR

She'll have a vodka tonic, make it two.

JOSIE

I feel so old here.

TERR
You're not old, trust me you look...

Terr's eyes scan Josie's body from bottom to top, taking a few seconds to stare into her eyes.

TERR (CONT'D)
Phenomenal.

The bartender places two drinks on the bar. Terr hands Josie her drink. Josie takes a long sip.

They dance, laugh, and Josie loosens up.

6 EXT. PARK -- AFTERNOON

Terr stands a few feet back, holding a professional camera. Josie stands stiffly in front of a tree, hands glued to her sides.

TERR
Okay, relax. You look like you're posing for your driver's license at the DMV.

JOSIE
Okay, we've done like fifty of these. I don't know how to be natural! Just tell me what to do.

TERR
If you want to get back out there, you need some spicy photos to add to your dating profile. Here, just -

Terr walks up to her, gently reaching for a piece of messy hair near Josie's cheek. She tucks it behind Josie's ear.

They're suddenly close. Josie freezes.

TERR (CONT'D)
There. Better.

Josie's breath catches. Terr steps back quickly, clearing her throat.

TERR (CONT'D)
Okay, uh, hands behind your back. Chin up. Look past me, like you're thinking about something important.

7 EXT. TERR'S CAR -- NIGHT

Josie and Terr stand beside the car.

JOSIE
I went on a date.

TERR
Yeah?

JOSIE
He talked about crypto and stocks the entire time. I nodded and smiled like I wasn't bored out of my mind. I literally faked going to the bathroom and climbed out a window.

Josie pauses and looks into Terr's eyes.

JOSIE (CONT'D)
I don't feel that with you. I always have more fun with you.

Terr's smile fades into something softer. They stare at each other. There's a silent moment.

Josie leans in first. Terr meets her halfway. They kiss. It's gentle, curious, and warm.

TERR
Wow.

8 EXT. SCHOOL PARKING LOT -- DAY

A SCHOOL MOM stands in a group of several other women with her phone out, zoomed in on a photo of Josie and Terr in the park, their faces close.

The women whisper and glance at Josie as she pulls into the school drop-off zone. Victoria and Madelyne get out of the car. Josie pulls forward toward the group and glances their way, confused. She continues to drive.

The women continue to whisper.

9 INT. LIVING ROOM -- AFTERNOON

Victoria bursts in.

VICTORIA
Why is there a picture of you kissing
(MORE)

VICTORIA (CONT'D)
some woman going around school?!

JOSIE
Victoria—

VICTORIA
Don't. What the hell is going on? Is
this why Dad left? Because you're a
lesbo?!

Josie's face crumples. Madelyne stands behind Victoria,
confused and scared.

JOSIE
That's not... I don't know what I feel
for her yet but I don't need to
justify my relationships to you.

VICTORIA
Are you serious right now?! I'm sick
of everyone hiding things from me. Dad
left and no one told us why, and now
this? I'm done. I want to live with
Dad.

Victoria storms upstairs and slams her bedroom door. Madelyne
flinches and begins to cry. Josie goes to hug her and cradle
her silently on the couch.

10 EXT. FRONT PORCH - MORNING

DAVID, Josie's ex-husband, walks out of the front door
holding a large suitcase. His car is running in the driveway.

DAVID
I told you, Josie. This is exactly the
kind of nonsense I meant. You need to
get it together.

Victoria leaves. Josie sobs.

11 INT. BEDROOM -- EVENING

Josie sits on the edge of her bed, phone buzzing nonstop, 5
missed calls from Terr. Terr's name keeps flashing
repeatedly.

TERR (TEXT)
Hey, are you alright?

TERR (TEXT) (CONT'D)

I heard one of the moms talking about
a picture of us.

I'm sorry it came out like that.

Just call me back, please.

She doesn't answer. She curls into herself under the covers
and cries.

12 INT. FOYER -- LATER

There is a knock at the door. Soft and hesitant.

Josie opens it. Terr stands outside, soaked from rain,
breathing hard.

TERR

You didn't answer. I got worried.

Josie's eyes fill with tears again. Terr steps forward and
pulls her into a tight hug. Josie melts into her.

Josie looks up at Terr, Terr looks down at her.

FADE OUT.

13 INT. KITCHEN -- SIX YEARS LATER (4TH OF JULY)

There is a photo on the fridge - Josie, Terr, Victoria, and
Madelyne, all smiling at a summer barbecue.

The camera pulls back to show a bustling kitchen decorated
for the 4th of July. Josie pulls a platter of food out of the
oven, Terr comes in from the backyard, drawing a World's Best
Chef apron and holding tongs.

Madelyne, now 16, runs through the kitchen to the backyard
holding sparklers, followed closely by a gaggle of young
children.

Victoria walks into the kitchen, holding hands with her BLUE
HAired GIRLFRIEND.

VICTORIA

Do you guys need any help?

TERR

Yeah, could you just grab that tray
and help me out back?

Victoria follows Terr outside. Josie looks back at them and smiles.

FADE OUT.